

The Kitchen Coder

Hi. I am Glen Kitchen, a Software Developer and Entrepreneur. I specialise in enterprise business software. Christian, husband, father.



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Location: KZN, South Africa

Availability: South Africa and UK (British passport)

About

I am a software developer with extensive experience in enterprise business software, combining specialized business process expertise with deep technical skills in full-stack web and mobile applications.

I have played a leading role in developing solutions for accounting, manufacturing, distribution, and retail.

I am open to contract and full-time work as a full-stack software developer: remote, hybrid, or on-site for periods. I hold a British passport, so I am available in both South Africa and the UK.

I build Kikstart with AI agents day to day: I run Claude Code in loops and scheduled routines, and write custom skills that capture my own development workflows.

Current Tech Skills

Typescript

React

Next.js

React Native

Expo

PostgreSQL

Neon

Multi-tenant SaaS

Claude Code

AI Agent Loops

Work Experience



Kikstart

Founder, Software Developer

Feb 2025 - Present

I am self-employed, building Kikstart: a multi-tenant SaaS platform for fast-tracked custom development. A customer's solution starts from maintained modules on the shared platform and is extended with custom features, instead of being built from scratch.

I develop it AI-first, directing AI agents (Claude Code) to build and ship features. That is what makes the fast-tracked delivery possible.

Typescript

Next.js

Expo

PostgreSQL

Neon

Claude Code

**Kodelab**

Co-founder (exited), Solution Architect

Mar 2021 - Jan 2025

3y 10m

I co-founded Kodelab, a custom software business spun out of Insight Consulting. I led the development team that built and extended a suite of web and mobile applications (distribution and retail) that became core to a division of one of South Africa's largest retailers, and owned the technical roadmap, infrastructure and delivery.

I also led ad hoc enterprise projects for other Kodelab customers, taking each from scoping and architecture through development and delivery. I engaged with customers and maintained those relationships.

MySQL

Typescript

React

Next.js

React Native

Expo

Azure

C#

.NET

**Insight Consulting**

Solution Architect

Nov 2019 - Feb 2021

1y 3m

I was solution architect for a suite of web and mobile applications (distribution and retail) for a division of one of South Africa's largest retailers, designing the technical architecture and infrastructure.

MySQL

Typescript

React

Next.js

React Native

Expo

Azure

C#

.NET

**Derivco**

Software Developer

May 2015 - Oct 2019

4y 5m

I was a full-stack senior developer on an in-house no-code framework, and led ad hoc projects.

The framework handled registrations and payments, processing tens of thousands of banking transactions a day.

I also worked on online gambling utility programs (loyalty, auditing, promotions).

SQL Server

Typescript

JavaScript

Angular.js

Azure

ASP.Net

C#

.NET

**AdaptIT**

Software Developer / Team Lead

Oct 2006 - Apr 2015

8y 6m

I was a full-stack developer and development team lead, working on accounting, sales and distribution, and warehousing applications, and led the team behind the SHEQ (Safety, Health, Environment, Quality) product suite.

I travelled extensively across South Africa and Africa for customer support and product rollout, and engaged senior business executives on sales and technical initiatives.

Oracle Certified (Expired)

Oracle Database

PL/SQL

Oracle Forms

Java

Microsoft Certified (Expired)

SQL Server

ASP.Net

WPF

C#

.NET



Van Dyck Carpets

Accountant / Developer

Apr 1999 - Sep 2006

7y 5m

This was a hybrid role with accounting and IT duties. On the accounting side I was initially the cost accountant and thereafter the management accountant responsible for overseeing the accounts department.

The IT projects were my introduction to software development: I managed the rollout of the Syspro ERP, oversaw development of in-house shop floor applications, and developed in-house sales reporting applications.

Windmill Restaurant

Restaurant Manager

Jun 1992 - Mar 1999

6y 9m

I worked as a restaurant manager while pursuing a sporting career as a Springbok bodyboarder and doing freelance accounting work.

Education



University of Cape Town

Bachelor of Social Science (Economics & Industrial Sociology)

1988 - 1990



Sea Point High School

Matric

1982 - 1987